

Prior Authorization Request

Health Plan

Humana Medicare Advantage -- Gold Choice PPO. Plan ID: H5216-014-000.

Member Information

Member: Patricia Yun-Harmon DOB: 1963-08-27 (age 63) Member ID: MBR-11077

Address: 29 Windermere Ave, Westerville, OH 43081

Phone: (614) 555-0162 Sex: F

Primary Insurance: Humana Medicare Advantage (primary). Secondary: none on file.

Referring / Requesting Provider

Dr. Marcus Delacroix, MD -- Orthopedic Spine Surgery

NPI: 1685904723 Practice: Capital City Spine Surgery

Phone: (614) 555-0200 Fax: (614) 555-0201

Requested Service

Elective inpatient admission, open lumbar spinal fusion, L3-L4

CPT 22612 ICD-10: M43.16 (Spondylolisthesis, lumbar region)

Planned admission date: 2026-11-21

Level of care requested: INPATIENT.

Prior Authorization Contact

Submitted via provider portal by: Jennifer Ruiz, Surgical Scheduling Coordinator.

Callback number: (614) 555-0199.

History and Physical

Chief Complaint

Low back pain with mild left leg discomfort, present for approximately 6 months.

History of Present Illness

The patient reports a 6-month history of low back pain with occasional mild radiation into the left buttock and posterior thigh, without clear dermatomal numbness. Symptoms are intermittent and tend to flare with prolonged standing. The patient has continued to work full duty throughout this period with occasional modified activity on flare days.

Past Medical History

No significant past medical history. Patient reports no chronic conditions and takes no regular medications.

Past Surgical History

None.

Medications

None on a regular basis; ibuprofen as needed for flares.

Allergies

No known drug allergies.

Physical Examination

Vital signs stable, well-appearing. Lumbar spine with mild decreased range of motion. Straight leg raise negative bilaterally. Motor strength 5/5 throughout. Sensation intact. Reflexes symmetric. Gait normal.

Surgeon Operative Plan

Diagnosis

Degenerative disc disease with instability, L3-L4.

Planned Procedure

Open posterior lumbar decompression and instrumented fusion, L3-L4.

Expected Hospital Course

Expected length of stay: 1 midnight. Patient is young, healthy, and anticipated to mobilize quickly.

Post-Operative Plan

Routine recovery with standard post-operative monitoring; discharge planning to begin the morning after surgery pending adequate pain control and mobility.

Imaging and Diagnostic Studies

Lumbar Spine Radiographs, Flexion-Extension Views

FINDINGS: Mild dynamic translation at the level in question on flexion-extension views, consistent with early segmental instability. No fracture or high-grade listhesis.

IMPRESSION: Mild instability, as above.

Conservative Treatment History

Timeline of Non-Operative Management

Physical therapy: 12 sessions over 8 weeks. One lumbar epidural steroid injection with partial, short-lived relief. NSAIDs used intermittently.

Total duration of conservative care: approximately 5 months.

Consent and Prior Authorization Summary

Shared Decision Making

Risks, benefits, and alternatives (continued conservative management, injection therapy, surgery) were discussed at length with the patient and her daughter, who was present as support. The patient expressed understanding of the surgical risks including infection, bleeding, nerve injury, hardware failure, and the possibility of incomplete symptom relief. The patient elected to proceed with surgical intervention after conservative measures failed to provide durable relief.

Payer Notice

This request is submitted under the member's Humana Medicare Advantage plan. Provider attests that the information contained in this packet is accurate and complete to the best of their knowledge as of the date of submission.